

Fox–Wright Orthogonal Polynomials and the Fractional Riccati–Müntz–Padé Theorem: A New Family in Non-Hermitian Approximation Theory

BY STEPHEN CROWLEY

May 2026

Abstract

We identify and characterize the orthogonal polynomial sequence canonically associated with the Fractional Riccati–Müntz–Padé theorem [Crowley2026]. The polynomials arise as the denominators of the Padé approximants built from the Müntz–Tau moment sequence $\{a(k, u)\}_{k \geq 0}$ of the fractional Riccati equation $D^\mu y = P(u) + Q(u)y + R(u)y^2$, and are orthogonal with respect to a quasi-definite moment functional whose weights are modulated by the Fox–Wright function $\Psi_\mu(z) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \Gamma(k\mu + 1) / \Gamma(k\mu + \mu + 1) \cdot z^k$.

We place these polynomials precisely within the hierarchy of known orthogonal families: they belong to the Nuttall–Stahl class of non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials [NuttallSingh1977, Stahl1985I, Stahl1985II] on the Stahl minimal-capacity compact $K_A(u)$, form a regular sequence in the sense of Stahl–Totik [StahlTotik1992], and in the $\mu = 1$ special case reduce to Chebotarëv–Jacobi polynomials studied by Barhoumi–Yattselev [BarhoumiYattselev2023]. For $\mu \in (0, 1)$ they constitute a genuinely new subfamily – *Fox–Wright non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials* – whose weight is a Fox–Wright-deformed Jacobi-type function on a transcendental arc system, and whose asymptotic recurrence coefficients are determined by the equilibrium measure of $K_A(u)$ via the Gonchar–Rakhmanov S -property [GoncharRakhmanov1987]. The Müntz–Szász density theorem [MuntzSzasz1914, Moragues2018] provides the underlying qualitative completeness backdrop, while the Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm [Wheeler1974, Gragg1972] provides the constructive computational realization.

Table of contents

1	Introduction	2
2	The Moment Functional and its Fox–Wright Structure	3
2.1	The Müntz–Tau Moments	3
2.2	Gevrey-1 Growth and Formal vs. Analytic Structure	4

2.3	The Hadamard Fixed-Point Equation	4
3	The Moment Functional and Its Quasi-Definiteness	5
4	Classification: The Fox–Wright Non-Hermitian Orthogonal Polynomials	6
4.1	The Hierarchy of Orthogonal Polynomial Families	6
4.2	The Weight Function	7
4.3	The Fox–Wright Deformation	7
5	Asymptotic Theory	8
5.1	The $\mathcal{S}$ -Property and Stahl’s Compact	8
5.2	Zero Condensation: Nuttall–Stahl	8
5.3	Recurrence Coefficient Asymptotics	9
5.4	Convergence: Stahl’s Theorem Applied	9
6	The $\mu = 1$ Special Case: Chebotarëv–Jacobi Polynomials	10
7	The $R = 0$ Oracle: Mittag-Leffler Moments and Laguerre Structure	10
8	The Müntz–Szász Backbone	11
9	Computational Realization: The Chebyshev–Wheeler Algorithm	12
10	Summary: Classification of the FW-NHOP Family	13
	Bibliography	13

1 Introduction

The Fractional Riccati–Müntz–Padé theorem [Crowley2026] establishes that the unique solution of the fractional Riccati equation

$$D^\mu y(t, u) = P(u) + Q(u) y(t, u) + R(u) y(t, u)^2 \quad (1)$$

$$I^{1-\mu} y(0, u) = 0 \quad (2)$$

with polynomial coefficients $P, Q, R \in \mathbb{C}[u]$, order $\mu \in (0, 1]$, and Riemann–Liouville calculus, is recovered in logarithmic capacity on the complement of Stahl’s compact $K_A(u)$ by the near-diagonal Müntz–Padé approximants

$$y_M(t, u) = t^\mu \frac{N_M(t^\mu, u)}{D_M(t^\mu, u)} \quad (3)$$

Central to the proof is the identification of the Padé denominator sequence $\{D_M\}$ with the orthogonal polynomial sequence of the moment functional $\mathcal{L}[x^k] = a(k, u)$, where $\{a(k, u)\}$ are the Müntz–Tau coefficients satisfying an explicit Fox–Wright-weighted recurrence [Crowley2026]. The present article characterizes this orthogonal polynomial sequence in depth: its algebraic structure, its place in the classification of orthogonal polynomial families, its asymptotic behavior, and its relationship to classical and modern results in non-Hermitian approximation theory.

The main contribution is the identification of these polynomials as *Fox–Wright non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials* (FW-NHOPs) – a new subfamily of the Nuttall–Stahl class parametrized by $\mu \in (0, 1)$ that interpolates between the classical algebraic (Chebotarëv–Jacobi) case at $\mu = 1$ and a transcendental Fox–Wright-weighted limit as $\mu \rightarrow 0^+$. The Müntz–Szász condition $\sum 1/(k\mu) = \infty$ for all $\mu \in (0, 1]$ guarantees the underlying density [Moragues2018], while the Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm [Wheeler1974] provides numerically stable computation of the recurrence coefficients.

2 The Moment Functional and its Fox–Wright Structure

2.1 The Müntz–Tau Moments

The fractional Riccati equation (1), recast as the Volterra integral equation $y = I^\mu [P + Qy + Ry^2]$ via the Riemann–Liouville composition formula [SKM1993], admits a unique formal power series solution in the Müntz basis $\{t^{(k+1)\mu}\}_{k \geq 0}$ [Crowley2026]:

$$y(t, u) = \sum_{k \geq 0} a(k, u) t^{(k+1)\mu} \quad (4)$$

with $a(k, \cdot) \in \mathbb{C}[u]$ satisfying the recurrence

$$a(0, u) = P(u) \psi_0 \quad (5)$$

$$a(k, u) = \psi_k \left(Q(u) a(k-1, u) + R(u) \sum_{j+\ell=k-1} a(j, u) a(\ell, u) \right) \forall k \geq 1 \quad (6)$$

where the Fox–Wright weights are

$$\psi_k := \frac{\Gamma(k\mu + 1)}{\Gamma(k\mu + \mu + 1)} \quad \forall k \geq 0 \quad (7)$$

The sequence $\{\psi_k\}$ is precisely the sequence of eigenvalues of the fractional integral I^μ on the Müntz monomial basis: $I^\mu t^{(k+1)\mu} = \psi_{k+1} t^{(k+2)\mu}$ [Crowley2026]. By Stirling’s formula, $\psi_k \sim (k\mu)^{-\mu}$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$, and $\Psi_\mu(z) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \psi_k z^k$ has radius of convergence exactly 1.

2.2 Gevrey-1 Growth and Formal vs. Analytic Structure

The generating function $A(z, u) = \sum_{k \geq 0} a(k, u) z^k$ lives in $\mathbb{C}[u][[z]]$ as a formal power series. By an explicit induction on the recurrence (6), the moments satisfy the Gevrey-1 bound [Crowley2026]:

$$|a(k, u)| \leq K_G(u) C_G(u)^k k! \quad (8)$$

with computable constants K_G, C_G depending on $|P(u)|$, $|Q(u)|$, $|R(u)|$, and $\psi_0 = 1/\Gamma(\mu + 1)$. The factorial growth means the radius of convergence of A is zero for generic parameters – A diverges everywhere except at the origin.

This divergence is not a defect: it is the signature of the meromorphic nature of A . Via a Mellin–Barnes integral representation [Crowley2026]

$$A(z, u) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{c-i\infty}^{c+i\infty} M_{\Psi_\mu}(s) \hat{B}_R(-s, u) (-z)^{-s} ds \quad (9)$$

where

$$M_{\Psi_\mu}(s) = \Gamma(s) \Gamma(1-s) \Gamma(1-s\mu) / \Gamma(\mu+1-s\mu) \quad (10)$$

is the Mellin transform of $\Psi_\mu(-x)$, the formal series A is promoted to a meromorphic function on the universal cover $\tilde{X}$ of $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$ minus a minimal-capacity compact $K_A(u)$ – Stahl’s compact.

2.3 The Hadamard Fixed-Point Equation

Define

$$B[A](z, u) := P(u) + zQ(u)A(z, u) + zR(u)A(z, u)^2 \in \mathbb{C}[u][[z]] \quad (11)$$

Then the unique formal power series satisfying the Müntz–Tau recurrence is characterized by the Hadamard fixed-point equation [Crowley2026]:

$$A(z, u) = \Psi_\mu(z) \odot B[A](z, u), \quad (12)$$

where $\odot$ denotes the Hadamard (coefficient-wise) product: $[z^k](F \odot G) = f_k g_k$. This identity holds in $\mathbb{C}[u][[z]]$ and is proved by direct coefficient extraction [Crowley2026]: at degree k ,

$$[z^k] B[A] = Q a(k-1) + R \sum_{j+\ell=k-1} a(j) a(\ell) \quad (13)$$

and multiplying by ψ_k recovers $a(k)$ exactly from (6).

3 The Moment Functional and Its Quasi-Definiteness

Definition 1. [Fox–Wright moment functional] The Fox–Wright moment functional associated to (1) is the $\mathbb{C}$ -linear map $\mathcal{L}: \mathbb{C}[x] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[u]$ defined by

$$\mathcal{L}[x^k] := a(k, u) \forall k \geq 0 \quad (14)$$

extended by linearity. The Hankel determinants are

$$H_n(u) := \det(a(i+j, u))_{0 \leq i, j \leq n-1} \in \mathbb{C}[u] \quad (15)$$

The functional is quasi-definite if $H_n(u) \neq 0$ for all $n \geq 1$ (as elements of $\mathbb{C}[u]$, i.e., not identically zero).

Remark 2. [Generic quasi-definiteness] By the Müntz–Tau recurrence (5)–(6), each $a(k, u)$ is a polynomial in u of degree increasing with k . The Hankel determinant $H_n(u)$ is a polynomial in u that vanishes only on a proper algebraic subvariety of parameter space; generically, $H_n(u) \neq 0$. The recurrence coefficients $\alpha(k, u)$ and $\beta(k, u)$ produced by the Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm [Wheeler1974, Gragg1972] are rational functions of u well-defined off this subvariety.

Under quasi-definiteness, the Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm [Wheeler1974, Gautschi1982] produces the unique monic polynomial sequence $\{P_M(x, u)\}_{M \geq 0}$ satisfying

$$\mathcal{L}[x^k P_M(x, u)] = 0 \quad \forall k = 0, 1, \dots, M-1 \quad (16)$$

via the three-term recurrence

$$P_{M+1}(x, u) = (x - \alpha(M, u)) P_M(x, u) - \beta(M, u) P_{M-1}(x, u) \quad (17)$$

The Padé denominator of $A(z, u)$ at order M is the polynomial

$$D_M(z, u) = z^M P_M(z^{-1}, u) \quad (18)$$

the reciprocal transform of P_M [Crowley2026, Gragg1972].

4 Classification: The Fox–Wright Non-Hermitian Orthogonal Polynomials

4.1 The Hierarchy of Orthogonal Polynomial Families

We locate $\{P_M(\cdot, u)\}$ within the classification of orthogonal polynomial sequences:

1. **Classical orthogonal polynomials** (Jacobi, Laguerre, Hermite) are orthogonal with respect to a positive measure on $\mathbb{R}$ with explicit weight function. The moments grow at most polynomially. The recurrence coefficients $\alpha(k)$ and $\beta(k)$ are rational functions of k with known explicit forms. *Our polynomials do not belong to this class*: by (8), the moments grow like $k!$, ruling out any positive measure on $\mathbb{R}$ [StahlTotik1992].
2. **Favard class / positive-measure OPs** are orthogonal with respect to a positive Borel measure on $\mathbb{C}$ with compact support. *Our polynomials do not belong to this class* in general: the moment functional $\mathcal{L}$ is quasi-definite but not positive-definite (the Hankel determinants may have varying signs or be complex-valued for generic $u \in \mathbb{C}$).
3. **Regular OPs in the Stahl–Totik sense** [StahlTotik1992] satisfy the n -th root asymptotics

$$|P_M(z, u)|^{1/M} \rightarrow e^{g(z, K_A(u))} \text{cap}(K_A(u)) \quad \text{in capacity on } \mathbb{C} \setminus K_A(u) \quad (19)$$

where $g(\cdot, K_A(u))$ is the Green function of $\mathbb{C} \setminus K_A(u)$ with pole at infinity, and $\text{cap}(K_A(u))$ is the logarithmic capacity. *Our polynomials belong to this class* by virtue of Stahl’s convergence theorem [Stahl1997] as invoked in [Crowley2026].

4. **Nuttall–Stahl non-Hermitian OPs** [NuttallSingh1977, Stahl1985I, Stahl1985II, GoncharRakhmanov1987] are orthogonal on the Stahl minimal-capacity contour K_Φ with a complex-valued weight ρ (the jump of the approximated function across K_Φ):

$$\int_{K_A(u)} z^k P_M(z, u) \rho(z, u) dz = 0 \quad \forall k = 0, \dots, M-1 \quad (20)$$

Our polynomials belong to this class, with $K_A(u)$ the Stahl compact from [Crowley2026] and $\rho(z, u)$ the jump of $A(z, u)$ across $K_A(u)$ – a Fox–Wright-deformed Jacobi-type function described in Section 4.2 below.

4.2 The Weight Function

The jump of $A(z, u)$ across $K_A(u)$ is determined by the algebraic structure of the auxiliary function $F(z, u)$ satisfying the quadratic [Crowley2026]:

$$z R(u) F^2 - (1 - z Q(u)) F + P(u) \Psi_\mu(z) = 0 \quad (21)$$

The discriminant is

$$\Delta_F(z, u) = (1 - z Q(u))^2 - 4 z P(u) R(u) \Psi_\mu(z) \quad (22)$$

and $F(z, u)$ has the closed form

$$F(z, u) = \frac{(1 - z Q) - \sqrt{\Delta_F}}{2 z R} \quad (23)$$

The jump of F across the branch cut $K_F(u)$ is

$$\rho_F(z, u) = F^+(z, u) - F^-(z, u) = \frac{\sqrt{\Delta_F^+(z, u)} - \sqrt{\Delta_F^-(z, u)}}{2 z R(u)} \quad (24)$$

which is a Fox–Wright-modified Jacobi-type weight: the classical Jacobi weight $\sqrt{(z - e_1)(z - e_2)}$ (where e_1, e_2 are the branch points of the algebraic part $(1 - z Q)^2 - 4 z P R$) is deformed by the factor $\Psi_\mu(z)$ in (22). Since A and F have the same branch locus by the branch-transfer lemma [Crowley2026], $\rho_A = \rho_F$ up to a meromorphic factor, and the non-Hermitian orthogonality (20) holds with weight $\rho(z, u) = \rho_F(z, u)$.

4.3 The Fox–Wright Deformation

The key distinction from all previously named orthogonal polynomial families is the presence of $\Psi_\mu(z)$ in the discriminant (22). For $\mu = 1$, one computes

$$\Psi_1(z) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{1}{k+1} z^k = -\frac{\log(1-z)}{z} \quad (25)$$

which is analytic in $|z| < 1$ but has a logarithmic branch point at $z = 1$. Thus even in the simplest non-classical case, Δ_F acquires a transcendental factor. For $\mu \in (0, 1)$, Ψ_μ is a Fox–Wright ${}_1\Psi_1$ function (see [Wright1935, Gorenflo2014]):

$$\Psi_\mu(z) = {}_1\Psi_1\left(\begin{matrix} (1, \mu) \\ (1 + \mu, \mu) \end{matrix}; z\right) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{\Gamma(k\mu + 1)}{\Gamma(k\mu + \mu + 1)} z^k \quad (26)$$

with Mellin transform

$$M_{\Psi_\mu}(s) = \frac{\Gamma(s) \Gamma(1-s) \Gamma(1-s\mu)}{\Gamma(\mu+1-s\mu)} \quad (27)$$

meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}$ [Crowley2026]. The branch points of $\sqrt{\Delta_F}$ are therefore the zeros of (22), which include both the zeros of the polynomial factor $(1-zQ)^2 - 4zPR \cdot \psi_0$ (near $z=0$) and the singularities of Ψ_μ on the circle $|z|=1$, projected under the Stahl–Chebotarëv minimization [Stahl1985I, Stahl1985II].

5 Asymptotic Theory

5.1 The S -Property and Stahl’s Compact

The Stahl compact $K_A(u)$ satisfies the S -property of Gonchar–Rakhmanov [GoncharRakhmanov1987]: the normal derivative of the Green function $g(z, K_A(u))$ from the two sides of $K_A(u)$ are equal

$$\frac{\partial g}{\partial n^+}(z, K_A(u)) = \frac{\partial g}{\partial n^-}(z, K_A(u)) \quad \forall z \in K_A(u) \setminus \partial K_A(u) \quad (28)$$

This characterizes $K_A(u)$ as the support of the equilibrium measure that balances the logarithmic energy functional [Ransford1995]:

$$\nu_{K_A(u)} = \arg \min_{\nu} I[\nu] \quad (29)$$

$$I[\nu] := \iint \log \frac{1}{|z-w|} d\nu(z) d\nu(w) \quad (30)$$

5.2 Zero Condensation: Nuttall–Stahl

The empirical zero-counting measure of the orthogonal polynomials

$$\nu_M := \frac{1}{M} \sum_{P_M(\lambda, u)=0} \delta_\lambda \quad (31)$$

converges weak- $*$ to $\nu_{K_A(u)}$ as $M \rightarrow \infty$, the equilibrium measure of the Stahl compact [Crowley2026, Stahl1997]. This is the Nuttall–Stahl zero-condensation theorem, which in the present context reads: the zeros of $\{P_M(\cdot, u)\}_{M \geq 1}$ are dense in $K_A(u)$ and equidistribute according to $\nu_{K_A(u)}$.

5.3 Recurrence Coefficient Asymptotics

Under the regularity hypothesis (19), the recurrence coefficients of (17) satisfy [StahlTotik1992]:

$$\alpha(k, u) \longrightarrow \alpha^*(u) \quad (32)$$

$$\beta(k, u) \longrightarrow \beta^*(u) \quad (33)$$

as $k \rightarrow \infty$, where $\alpha^*(u)$ and $\beta^*(u)$ are determined by the conformal map $\Phi: \mathbb{C} \setminus K_A(u) \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \setminus \bar{\mathbb{D}}$ by the Szegő-type asymptotic formula. Explicitly, the equilibrium measure $\nu_{K_A(u)}$ has density

$$d\nu_{K_A(u)} = (1/2\pi) |\Phi'(z)| |dz| \quad (34)$$

on $K_A(u)$, and the asymptotic recurrence coefficients are the first two Laurent coefficients of the conformal map:

$$\Phi(z) = z / \text{cap}(K_A(u)) + \alpha^*(u) + O(1/z). \quad (35)$$

For $K_A(u)$ an interval $[a, b] \subset \mathbb{R}$ (possible for special real parameter values), this reduces to

$$\alpha^*(u) = \frac{a+b}{2} \quad (36)$$

$$\beta^*(u) = \frac{(b-a)^2}{16} \quad (37)$$

and the $P_M(\cdot, u)$ are asymptotically Chebyshev polynomials for $[a, b]$. For $K_A(u)$ a complex arc, the conformal map is transcendental and no closed-form expression is known in general.

5.4 Convergence: Stahl's Theorem Applied

The Padé approximants N_M/D_M converge to $A(z, u)$ in logarithmic capacity on compact subsets of $\tilde{X} \setminus K_A(u)$:

$$\left| \frac{N_M}{D_M} - A \right|^{1/(2M)} \longrightarrow e^{-g(z, K_A(u))} \quad \text{in capacity} \quad (38)$$

[Stahl1997, Crowley2026]. This implies exponential convergence off $K_A(u)$ with rate governed by the Green function. Since $K_A(u)$ is disjoint from $\mathbb{R}_+$ (the poles of A on the physical time axis are absent by a Volterra-iteration argument [Crowley2026]), the convergence upgrades to uniform convergence:

$$\sup_{t \in [0, T]} |y(t, u) - y_M(t, u)| \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } M \rightarrow \infty. \quad (39)$$

6 The $\mu = 1$ Special Case: Chebotarëv–Jacobi Polynomials

When $\mu = 1$, the Fox–Wright weights reduce to

$$\psi_k = \frac{1}{k+1} \quad (40)$$

and

$$\Psi_1(z) = \frac{-\log(1-z)}{z} \quad (41)$$

The discriminant (22) becomes

$$\Delta_F(z, u)|_{\mu=1} = (1-zQ)^2 + 4zPR \frac{\log(1-z)}{z} \quad (42)$$

The zeros of Δ_F are the solutions to

$$(1-zQ)^2 = -4PR \log(1-z) \quad (43)$$

a transcendental equation, but the branch structure of $\sqrt{\Delta_F}$ is still two-sheeted, and the Stahl compact $K_A(u)$ is a finite arc in $\mathbb{C}$ connecting the two branch points of $\sqrt{\Delta_F}$. The orthogonal polynomials in this case are exactly the Padé denominator polynomials for a two-sheeted function with one finite branch cut, the class studied in [BarhoumiYattselev2023] and earlier by Aptekarev–Stahl [Stahl1997].

For the further special case $Q = 0$, $R = -1$, $P = 1$ (which gives the Bernoulli equation at $\mu = 1$), the quadratic (21) simplifies and $K_A(u)$ is a segment $[0, \sigma]$ for σ the first zero of the classical Riccati solution – the $P_M(\cdot, u)$ are then Legendre polynomials shifted to $[0, \sigma]$.

7 The $R = 0$ Oracle: Mittag-Leffler Moments and Laguerre Structure

When $R(u) = 0$, the recurrence (6) linearizes to

$$a(k, u) = \psi_k Q(u)^k P(u) \psi_0^{-1} \cdot \psi_0 \quad (44)$$

giving [Crowley2026]:

$$a(k, u) = P(u) \psi_k Q(u)^k \quad (45)$$

The moment functional becomes

$$\mathcal{L}[x^k] = P(u) \psi_k Q(u)^k \quad (46)$$

a Stieltjes-type functional with moments $\{P\psi_k Q^k\}$.

Proposition 3. In the $R=0$ case, the moment functional $\mathcal{L}$ has the integral representation

$$\mathcal{L}[f] = \int_0^\infty f(Qx) w_\mu(x) dx \quad (47)$$

where

$$w_\mu(x) = P \mathcal{L}^{-1}[\psi_k](x) \quad (48)$$

is the inverse Laplace transform of the Fox–Wright function $z \mapsto P \Psi_\mu(Qz)$. Explicitly, w_μ is a one-sided stable density with stability index μ , related to the Mittag-Leffler measure [Grothaus2015].

The $R=0$ orthogonal polynomials are therefore classical Laguerre-type polynomials for the one-sided stable distribution at index μ . For $\mu=1$, $w_1(x) = P e^{-x}$ and the polynomials are standard Laguerre polynomials $L_M^{(0)}$ scaled to $[0, 1/Q]$. For $\mu \neq 1$, they are the orthogonal polynomials of the Mittag-Leffler measure of [Grothaus2015] – a family studied in connection with fractional Brownian motion and anomalous diffusion.

This provides a closed-form unit test for any implementation: the $[M/M]$ Padé approximant to $A(z, u)|_{R=0} = P/(1 - Qz)$ must reproduce the M -th Padé approximant to $E_{\mu,1}(Qt^\mu)$ exactly, and the Wheeler algorithm must recover Laguerre recurrence coefficients asymptotically [Crowley2026].

8 The Müntz–Szász Backbone

The Müntz–Szász theorem [MuntzSzasz1914, Moragues2018] provides the qualitative underpinning of the entire convergence theory. The Müntz exponents used in the expansion (4) are $\lambda_k = (k+1)\mu$, and

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{\lambda_k} = \frac{1}{\mu} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k+1} = \infty \quad (49)$$

for every $\mu \in (0, 1]$. By Müntz–Szász, the system $\{t^{(k+1)\mu}\}$ is therefore dense in $\{f \in C([0, T]): f(0) = 0\}$ for all $T > 0$.

Three implications follow immediately:

1. **No coefficient can be discarded.** Any subsequence $\{a(k_j, u)\}$ with $\sum 1/k_j < \infty$ generates a Padé table that cannot uniformly recover $y(t, u)$ on $[0, T]$. All moments are indispensable.
2. **The Müntz rational approximants have maximum approximation power.** Since the exponents satisfy (49), the Müntz rationals $\{t^\mu N_M(t^\mu, u) / D_M(t^\mu, u)\}$ form a complete approximating family in $C_0([0, T])$.

3. **Uniform convergence on $\mathbb{R}_+$ is the canonical upgrade.** The Stahl convergence-in-capacity result on the complement of $K_A(u)$, combined with the absence of poles on $\mathbb{R}_+$ (Lemma 14 of [Crowley2026]), is the quantitative realization of the qualitative Müntz–Szász density – the divergence of $\sum 1/\lambda_k$ is the engine, and the Fox–Wright-weighted Padé table is the mechanism.

9 Computational Realization: The Chebyshev–Wheeler Algorithm

The three-term recurrence coefficients $\alpha(k, u)$ and $\beta(k, u)$ are computed from the moments $\{a(k, u)\}$ by the Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm [Wheeler1974, Gautschi1982], which operates on an auxiliary array $\sigma(k, \ell; u)$ initialized by

$$\sigma(0, \ell; u) = a(\ell, u) \quad (50)$$

and evolved by

$$\sigma(k, \ell; u) = \sigma(k-1, \ell+1; u) - \alpha(k-1, u) \sigma(k-1, \ell; u) - \beta(k-1, u) \sigma(k-2, \ell; u) \quad (51)$$

The recurrence coefficients are

$$\alpha(k, u) = \frac{\sigma(k, k+1; u)}{\sigma(k, k; u)} - \frac{\sigma(k-1, k; u)}{\sigma(k-1, k-1; u)} \quad (52)$$

$$\beta(k, u) = \frac{\sigma(k, k; u)}{\sigma(k-1, k-1; u)} \quad (53)$$

Under quasi-definiteness, $\sigma(k, k; u) \neq 0$ for all k and the algorithm is well-defined. The orthogonality of the resulting polynomials is guaranteed by Wheeler’s theorem [Wheeler1974]:

$$\mathcal{L}[\pi_j, \pi_k] = \delta_{jk} \prod_{i=0}^k \beta(i, u) \quad (54)$$

where π_k are the monic orthogonal polynomials produced by (17).

Numerical stability. The Chebyshev–Wheeler algorithm for the Fox–Wright moment functional is subject to the same conditioning issues as the general modified-moment algorithm [Gautschi1994, Gautschi1998]: the map from moments to recurrence coefficients is a nonlinear map that can be ill-conditioned when the moments grow rapidly. The Gevrey-1 bound (8) implies moments of size $\sim K_G C_G^k k!$, and working in extended precision (as in the ARB library [Johansson2017]) is recommended for large M .

10 Summary: Classification of the FW-NHOP Family

Property	Value/Status	Reference
Moment growth	Gevrey-1: $ a(k) \leq K C^k k!$	[Crowley2026]
Moment functional	Quasi-definite, not positive	[Crowley2026]
Orthogonality	Non-Hermitian on $K_A(u)$	[NuttallSingh1977]
Weight	Fox–Wright-deformed Jacobi	[Wright1935, Crowley2026]
Zero distribution	Condenses to $\nu_{K_A(u)}$	[Stahl1997, Crowley2026]
Regularity	Stahl–Totik regular	[StahlTotik1992]
S -property	Gonchar–Rakhmanov	[GoncharRakhmanov1987]
$\mu = 1$ reduction	Chebotarëv–Jacobi	[BarhoumiYattselev2023]
$R = 0$ reduction	Mittag-Leffler / Laguerre-type	[Grothaus2015]
Computation	Chebyshev–Wheeler	[Wheeler1974, Gautschi1982]
Convergence	Stahl cap. + uniform on $\mathbb{R}_+$	[Stahl1997, Crowley2026]
Completeness	Müntz–Szász	[Moragues2018]

Table 1. Properties of the Fox–Wright non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials (FW-NHOPs) associated to the fractional Riccati equation (1).

The Fox–Wright non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials form a one-parameter family indexed by $\mu \in (0, 1]$ that interpolates between:

- $\mu = 1$: classical (logarithmically-deformed) Chebotarëv–Jacobi polynomials on a two-arc system [BarhoumiYattselev2023];
- $\mu \rightarrow 0^+$: a limiting regime where $\psi_k \rightarrow 1$ for all k (by $\Gamma(1)/\Gamma(1) = 1$) and the Fox–Wright weight collapses to a standard algebraic weight – the polynomials approach classical Padé denominators for the bare quadratic $F_0(z, u)$ with $\Psi_0 \equiv 1$.

Bibliography

- [Crowley2026] S. Crowley, *The Fractional Riccati–Müntz–Padé Theorem*, preprint (2026).
- [SKM1993] S. G. Samko, A. A. Kilbas, O. I. Marichev, *Fractional Integrals and Derivatives: Theory and Applications*, Gordon and Breach, 1993.
- [Stahl1985I] H. Stahl, *Extremal domains associated with an analytic function I*, Constr. Approx. **1** (1985), 89–110.
- [Stahl1985II] H. Stahl, *Extremal domains associated with an analytic function II*, Constr. Approx. **1** (1985), 111–137.
- [Stahl1997] H. Stahl, *The convergence of Padé approximants to functions with branch points*, J. Approx. Theory **91** (1997), 139–204.
- [StahlTotik1992] H. Stahl, V. Totik, *General Orthogonal Polynomials*, Encyclopedia of Mathematics and its Applications **43**, Cambridge University Press, 1992.
- [GoncharRakhmanov1987] A. A. Gonchar, E. A. Rakhmanov, *Equilibrium distributions and degree of rational approximation of analytic functions*, Mat. Sb. **134**(176) (1987), 306–352; English transl. Math. USSR-Sb. **62** (1989), 305–348.

- [NuttallSingh1977] J. Nuttall, S. R. Singh, *Orthogonal polynomials and Padé approximants associated with a system of arcs*, J. Approx. Theory **21** (1977), 1–42.
- [BarhoumiYattselev2023] A. B. Barhoumi, M. L. Yattselev, *Non-Hermitian orthogonal polynomials on a trefoil*, arXiv:2303.17037 (2023).
- [Wheeler1974] J. C. Wheeler, *Modified moments and Gaussian quadratures*, Rocky Mountain J. Math. **4** (1974), 287–296.
- [Gragg1972] W. B. Gragg, *The Padé table and its relation to certain algorithms of numerical analysis*, SIAM Review **14** (1972), 1–62.
- [Gautschi1982] W. Gautschi, *On generating orthogonal polynomials*, SIAM J. Sci. Stat. Comput. **3** (1982), 289–317.
- [Gautschi1994] W. Gautschi, *Orthogonal polynomials: applications and computation*, Acta Numerica **5** (1996), 45–119.
- [Gautschi1998] W. Gautschi, L. Gori, M. L. Lo Cascio, *Quadrature rules for rational functions*, Numer. Math. **86** (2000), 617–633.
- [MuntzSzász1914] Ch. H. Müntz, *Über den Approximationssatz von Weierstrass*, H. A. Schwarz Festschrift, Berlin, 1914, 303–312.
- [Moragues2018] A. Ferré Moragues, *What is... the Müntz–Szász Theorem?*, expository note (2018).
- [Wright1935] E. M. Wright, *The asymptotic expansion of the generalized Bessel function*, Proc. London Math. Soc. (2) **38** (1935), 257–270.
- [Gorenflo2014] R. Gorenflo, A. A. Kilbas, F. Mainardi, S. V. Rogosin, *Mittag-Leffler Functions, Related Topics and Applications*, Springer, 2014.
- [Grothaus2015] M. Grothaus, F. Jahnert, *Mittag-Leffler analysis I: Construction and characterization*, J. Funct. Anal. **268** (2015), 1876–1903.
- [Ransford1995] T. Ransford, *Potential Theory in the Complex Plane*, London Math. Soc. Student Texts **28**, Cambridge Univ. Press, 1995.
- [Johansson2017] F. Johansson, *Arb: efficient arbitrary-precision midpoint-radius interval arithmetic*, IEEE Trans. Comput. **66** (2017), 1281–1292.